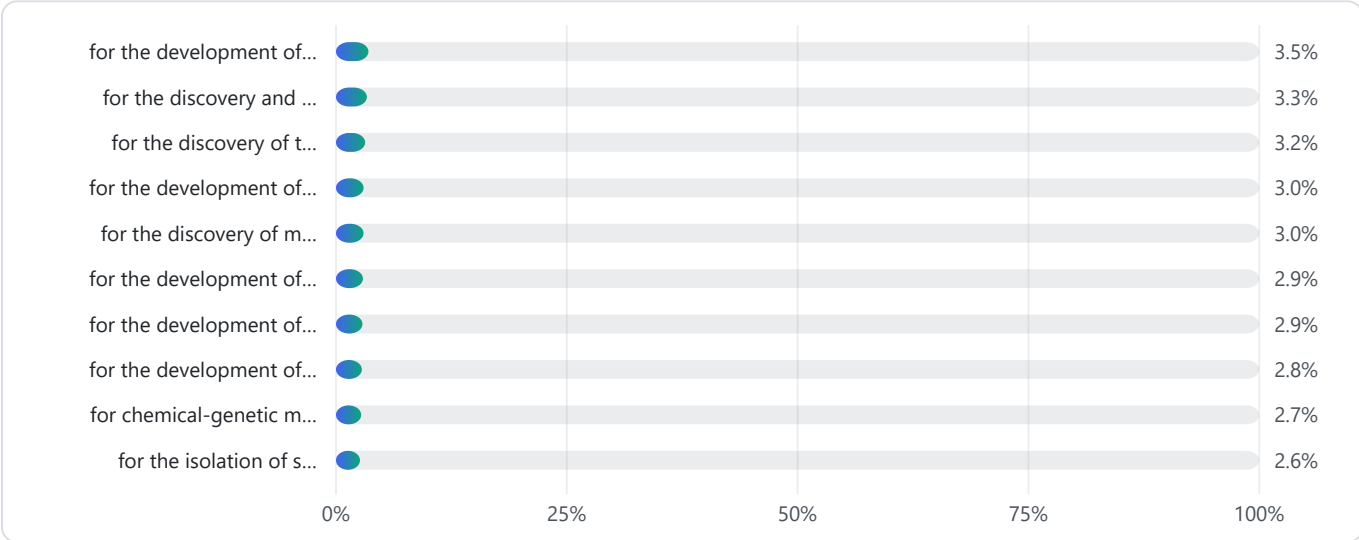
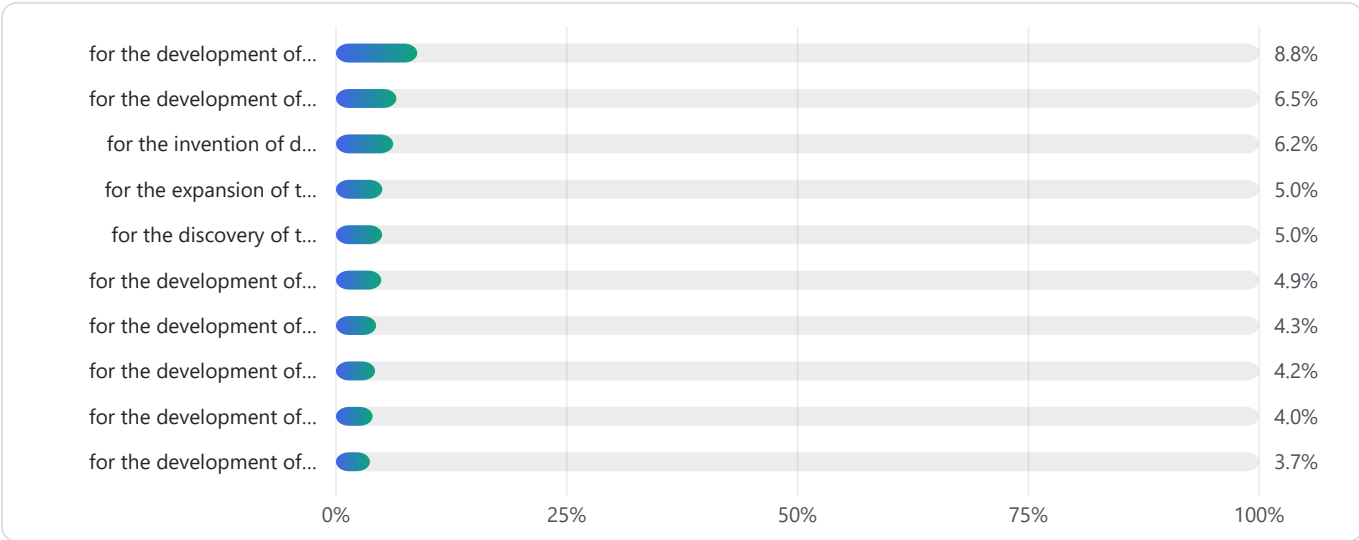


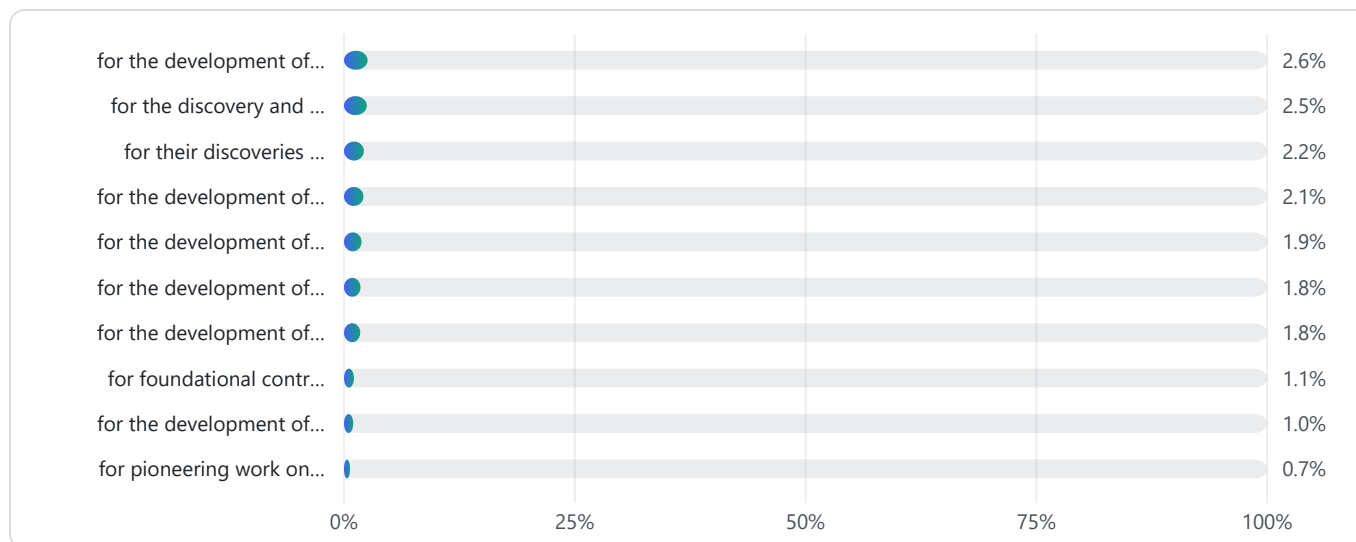


Which discovery will the 2026 Nobel Prize in Chemistry be awarded for?

Generated 2026년 10월 6일 오후 5:40

Forecast distribution





Full option labels

1. for the development of mass-spectrometry-based proteomics — John R. Yates III, Matthias Mann, Ruedi Aebersold
2. for the development of self-assembled monolayers on solid surfaces — David L. Allara, Ralph G. Nuzzo, George M. Whitesides
3. for the invention of dye-sensitized solar cells — Michael Grätzel
4. for the expansion of the genetic code to incorporate unnatural amino acids into proteins — Peter G. Schultz, Jason W. Chin
5. for the discovery of the nuclear receptor superfamily of ligand-regulated transcription factors — Ronald M. Evans
6. for the development of massively parallel sequencing-by-synthesis of DNA — Shankar Balasubramanian, David Klenerman
7. for the development of nanopore methods for single-molecule analysis and sequencing of nucleic acids — Hagan Bayley, David W. Deamer, Daniel Branton
8. for the development of palladium-catalyzed carbon-heteroatom bond formation — Stephen L. Buchwald, John F. Hartwig
9. for the development of controlled radical polymerization — Krzysztof Matyjaszewski, Mitsuo Sawamoto
10. for the development of polymeric and lipid nanoparticle systems for the delivery of drugs and nucleic acids — Pieter R. Cullis
11. for the development of base editing and prime editing for precise genome editing — David R. Liu
12. for the discovery and development of solid-state perovskite solar cells — Henry J. Snaith, Tsutomu Miyasaka, Nam-Gyu Park
13. for the discovery of targeted protein degradation by small molecules that redirect ubiquitin ligases — Craig M. Crews, Raymond J. Deshaies
14. for the development of phosphoramidite chemistry for automated DNA synthesis — Marvin H. Caruthers
15. for the discovery of molecular chaperones that assist protein folding in the cell — Arthur L. Horwich, F. Ulrich Hartl

16. for the development of accurate exchange-correlation functionals that made density functional theory the workhorse of computational chemistry — John P. Perdew
17. for the development of ab initio molecular dynamics — Michele Parrinello, Roberto Car
18. for the development of programmable and chemoenzymatic synthesis of complex carbohydrates and glycoproteins — Chi-Huey Wong
19. for chemical-genetic methods to study protein kinases and the discovery of covalent inhibitors of oncogenic KRAS — Kevan Shokat
20. for the isolation of stable carbenes and the development of N-heterocyclic carbenes as ligands in catalysis — Anthony J. Arduengo III, Guy Bertrand, Wolfgang A. Herrmann
21. for the development of efficient organic light-emitting diodes — Ching W. Tang, Steven A. Van Slyke
22. for the discovery and development of semiconductor photocatalysis for water splitting — Akira Fujishima, Kazunari Domen
23. for their discoveries of chemical communication in bacteria — Bonnie L. Bassler, E. Peter Greenberg
24. for the development of dye-sensitized and perovskite solar cells — Michael Grätzel, Henry J. Snaith, Tsutomu Miyasaka
25. for the development of chemical methods for the synthesis and massively parallel sequencing of DNA — Shankar Balasubramanian, David Klenerman, Marvin H. Caruthers
26. for the development of DNA origami and programmable self-assembly of DNA nanostructures — Paul W. K. Rothemund, William M. Shih, Hao Yan
27. for the development of transition-metal-catalyzed C-H functionalization reactions — John F. Hartwig, Robert G. Bergman
28. for foundational contributions to the theory and understanding of proton-coupled electron transfer — Sharon Hammes-Schiffer, Thomas J. Meyer
29. for the development of atomic layer deposition — Tuomo Suntola
30. for pioneering work on electron transfer in proteins — Harry B. Gray

TL;DR

Mass-spectrometry-based proteomics is the leading discovery at 9% (calculation audit). Self-assembled monolayers follow at 7%, and dye-sensitized solar cells at 6% (calculation audit). No option reaches 10%, and an unlisted winning discovery annuls this conditional question (resolution and audit).

Context

The Chemistry announcement is scheduled for October 7, 2026, at 11:45 CEST at the earliest, equivalent to 09:45 UTC (official schedule). I use October 6, 2026, 22:06 UTC—the client's original question time—as the evidence cutoff, not the later review time (scope). Resolution

follows the official discovery motivation, not an exact match to the displayed names; the larger-share, first-mentioned and most-specific-match rules apply (resolution).

The supplied profiles are the main evidence. They use the January 2026 OpenAlex snapshot and December 31, 2025 patent snapshot, with works and granted patents through 2021; impact and disruption are five-year cohort percentiles, Foundation is a share, and patents, inventions, books and collaborators are counts (supplied evidence). I accept the supplied Medicine and Physics outcomes as premises and use them only for the permitted credit, realization, recognition and demographic calibration (premises).

Evidence

The historical backbone is the supplied Chemistry timing record for 2000–2025, covering 26 prizes: about 15–20% had discovery-to-award lags of ten years or less, about a third waited 10–25 years, and about 45% waited longer; the median was roughly 25 years (timing premise). The fast cases were already field-wide tools. I therefore apply one maturity factor inside the profile ranking: 0.55 for a displayed realization at most ten years old, 1.00 for 11–25 years, and 1.15 beyond 25 years. These are prior weights, not fitted annual award hazards; they chiefly constrain base/prime editing, without another recency penalty later (model inputs).

The profile reference pool contains 61 past Chemistry laureates measured at prize time. The separate demographic premise covers 26 prizes, 68 awards and 67 people: 62 men and five women, with 40 awards at US affiliations; its area counts are 11 biochemical/chemical-biological prizes, six synthesis/catalysis, five materials and four physical/analytical/theoretical prizes (reference pools). I keep the denominators separate. Birthplace and citizenship receive neutral factors because these outcome counts lack the eligible-candidate denominator. Countries of work, scientific area and recent female representation enter only through the modest factors below. The supplied all-male, US/German-centered Medicine and Physics results create neither a quota nor a topical veto (demographic judgments).

The aggregation rule is the same for every option: 0.60 times the strongest named contributor's grade plus 0.40 times the mean named-contributor grade, applied separately to career and discovery evidence. A solo option receives its contributor's full grade. Repeated people contribute their complete career record to both options, while shared papers and patents are counted once within an option (aggregation audit). The supplied cross-committee outcomes support emphasizing decisive realization and leadership rather than conceptual priority or collaboration size; their recognition-cascade lesson keeps outside boosts bounded (calibration premises).

Career grades combine impact, technological translation, textbook reach and collaboration with weights 0.35, 0.25, 0.30 and 0.10. Discovery grades assess the relevant papers' impact,

disruption, Foundation share and uptake, together with the tied patents and the realization they disclose. Both are judgment-coded against the supplied reference lines, not fitted selection probabilities. The option score combines career and discovery grades with weights 0.45 and 0.55 (complete grades). This preserves strong patent-heavy inventions without making patent ownership a requirement for theoretical chemistry.

Every reliability adjustment is explicit. Career evidence is shrunk toward a neutral grade by factor 0.90 for Grätzel, Yates, Hartl, Balasubramanian, Hao Yan, Evans, Gray, Bertrand, Mann, Car, Bergman and Chin; 0.80 for Rothmund and Herrmann; 0.85 for Hammes-Schiffer; and 0.95 for Liu. The reasons are the visible early publication windows, historical or repeated coauthor anomalies, and questionable affiliation assignments—not a rejection of their identifiable discovery works. All other career reliability factors are 1.00 (individual flags). Van Slyke's 15-work sample receives a separate 0.85 shrinkage on career impact only; his OLED patents retain full discovery weight. Relevant post-2018 uptake receives confidence factor 0.65, with completed impact windows unchanged. Original demonstrations receive full realization emphasis, reviews 0.35 and supporting applications 0.50; their uptake still counts (reliability and evidence roles).

The discovery allocation is below. W1–W3 and P1–P3 mean the works and patents in their order on each supplied card. Unlisted works receive no discovery credit but remain in career evidence; reviews and enabling work are distinguished from invention authorship. Mixed-discovery patent totals are not silently assigned in full to both discoveries (allocation rules).

Discovery	Discovery-relevant works and patents
Sequencing-by-synthesis	Balasubramanian W1/P1–3; Klennerman W1/P1.
Controlled radical polymerization	Matyjaszewski W1–3/P1–3; Sawamoto W1–3/P1.
Solid-state perovskites	Snaith W1–3/P1–3; Miyasaka W1–2; Park W1–3/P1–3.
Drug/nucleic-acid nanoparticles	Cullis W1–3/P1–3.
Phosphoramidite synthesis	Caruthers W1, W3/P1–3.
C–H functionalization	Hartwig W1/P3; Bergman W1–3/P1–3.
Nanopore methods	All three profiles W1–3 and all listed patents; structures and fabrication are enabling.
Self-assembled monolayers	Allara W1–3/P1; Nuzzo W1–2/P1–3; Whitesides W2–3/P1–3.
Protein electron transfer	Gray P1, supporting only; no displayed paper directly establishes this discovery.
Base/prime editing	Liu W1–3/P1–3.
Targeted degradation	Crews W1–3/P1–3; Deshaies W1–3/P1; ligase reviews are context.
Ab initio dynamics	Parrinello W3; Car W1–2; software supports uptake.

Discovery	Discovery-relevant works and patents
Molecular chaperones	Horwich W1-3/P1-3; Hartl W1-3/P1-2; exclude vaccine P3.
Dye + perovskite cells	Grätzel W1-3/P1-3 plus the relevant Snaith and Miyasaka evidence.
OLEDs	Van Slyke W1-3/P1-3; Tang W2-3/P1-3.
DNA origami	Rothemund W1-2/P1-3; Shih and Yan W1-3 and their listed patents.
Pd carbon-heteroatom coupling	Buchwald W1, W3/P1-3; Hartwig W2-3/P1-2.
DNA synthesis + sequencing	Union of the sequencing and phosphoramidite evidence.
DFT functionals	Perdew W1-3; no patent requirement.
Chemical genetics/KRAS	Shokat P1-3; displayed papers do not directly establish the named inventions.
Genetic-code expansion	Schultz W3/P1-3; Chin W1-3 and listed patents.
Atomic layer deposition	Suntola W1-3/P1-3.
Carbohydrate synthesis	Wong W3/P1-3.
MS-based proteomics	Yates W1-2 and MS patents; Mann W1-3/P1-3; Aebersold W1-3 and patents.
Dye-sensitized cells	Grätzel W1-2/P1-3; exclude perovskite W3.
Stable carbenes/NHCs	Arduengo and Bertrand W1-3/P1-3; Herrmann W1-2/P1-3.
Bacterial communication	Bassler and Greenberg W1-3/P1-3; biofilm work is supporting.
Photocatalytic water splitting	Fujishima W1-2/P1; Domen W1-3/P1-3.
Proton-coupled electron transfer	Hammes-Schiffer W1-2; Meyer W1, W3/P1.
Nuclear receptors	Evans W1, W3/P1-3.

The strongest profile case is proteomics. The supplied samples contain 1,014 Yates works, 797 Mann works and 788 Aebersold works, ending in 2021; the first two early window starts trigger the reliability adjustment. All three distinct-book comparisons exceed the reference cohort. Yates's database-search work combines disruption 0.75 with 347 invention citations; Mann's displayed experimental methods have disruption 0.92 and 0.96; Aebersold's peptide-validation work has Foundation share 0.77 (supplied proteomics evidence). These are complementary identification, measurement and interpretation advances, not merely a large coauthor network.

SAMs combine a mature surface realization with platform reach. Allara and Nuzzo supply the origin and characterization evidence; Whitesides supplies patterning and applications. His supplied record contains 10,467 citing inventions, 185 patents and 8,837 distinct citing books,

while the relevant microstamping patent has 1,040 later-patent citations (supplied SAM evidence). The original discovery and enabling applications both matter.

Dye-sensitized cells retain a strong solo profile. Grätzel's supplied career-impact comparisons exceed 84%, 84% and 89% of the reference laureates, and both textbook comparisons exceed that cohort. The specific cell paper has disruption 0.76, Foundation share 0.36, 576 invention citations and 24 citing books, supported by the three photoelectrochemical-cell patents (supplied dye-cell evidence). The perovskite deposition paper does not earn discovery credit for this narrower option.

Genetic-code expansion also exceeds the exact 5% threshold in the submitted calculation. Schultz supplies exceptional translation, including 173 patents and 85 discovery-related patents; Chin's incorporation paper combines disruption 0.93 and Foundation share 0.64. The roughly two-decade realization history fits the mature-tool prior (supplied genetic-code evidence). Its unrelated nanocrystal and circadian papers remain career evidence only.

I pursued three scope tests: whether proteomics repeats an already awarded discovery, whether SAM credit can fit a coherent award, and whether patent-heavy realization is being lost in paper-heavy career comparisons. The official earlier mass-spectrometry motivation concerns soft ionization, rather than the full quantitative-proteomics tool chain (Nobel motivation). Kavli's recognition separates SAM formation, characterization and engineering contributions (committee attribution). The ALD award account establishes industrial realization through patents and equipment (Millennium account). These findings reject blanket “already awarded” or “few papers” penalties; they do not replace the supplied profiles.

Outside evidence changes weights only at the margin. The following are all non-neutral secondary factors; every other option keeps 1.00:

- Sequencing-by-synthesis, 1.60; combined synthesis/sequencing, 1.15. The announced Princess of Asturias recognition corroborates the sequencing platform and Mayer's enabling amplification, but supports only one branch of the composite option (award institution).
- Controlled radical polymerization, 1.15, for the ATRP-specific Blaise Pascal recognition announced July 21, 2026 (Carnegie Mellon).
- Solid-state perovskites, 1.10. Oxford PV reported its first commercial shipment on September 5, 2024. This is vendor evidence of realization, not independent proof of industry-wide adoption (company announcement).
- Delivery nanoparticles, 1.15, for the Tang Prize's specific attribution of ionizable-lipid delivery (Tang Prize).

- SAMs, 1.35; protein electron transfer, 1.50; base/prime editing, 1.20. Clarivate's recognition corroborates these discovery boundaries, including a discovery absent from Gray's displayed papers. SAMs also has Kavli recognition; these overlapping signals are not multiplied independently (Clarivate; Kavli).
- Targeted degradation, 1.35, following FDA approval of the heterobifunctional degrader vepdegestrant on May 1, 2026 (FDA).
- Chaperones, 1.10, for the September 18, 2026 Keio announcement recognizing chaperone-mediated folding (Keio).
- Palladium carbon–heteroatom coupling, 1.05, for the discovery-specific Wolf attribution; the evidence is longstanding and overlapping (Wolf Foundation).
- Genetic-code expansion, 1.10, for the Welch recognition announced May 20, 2025 (Scripps).
- ALD, 1.20, for independent corroboration of industrial realization (Millennium Prize).
- Dye-sensitized cells and the combined solar option, each 1.05, for the older dye-cell recognition; it supports that branch, not a perovskite-only motivation (EPFL).
- Proteomics, 1.35. The March 31, 2026 institutional announcement groups the exact trio around systems proteomics. Its date is corroborated independently of the inconsistent opening dateline in the award foundation's release (Max Planck; Gairdner).

The probability conversion is:

$$u_i = \exp [7 (0.45C_i + 0.55D_i - 0.50)] T_i H_i, \qquad p_i = \frac{(u_i G_i A_i)^{0.95}}{\sum_j (u_j G_j A_j)^{0.95}}.$$

Here C and D are the aggregated career and discovery grades; T is maturity; H is motivation specificity; G is demographics; and A is secondary evidence. The two composite solar/DNA options receive H=0.45 because a narrow motivation resolves to their more-specific rivals; all other H values are 1.00. The common exponent 0.95 tempers uncertainty identically across all options. No uniform floor is added, and no betting prices or crowd forecast aggregates enter the calculation (full numerical audit).

This table reports the profiles-only distribution, the distribution after demographics, and the submitted distribution after secondary evidence and calibration. G and A are weight multipliers, not probabilities. Displayed probabilities are rounded; the JSON retains normalized arithmetic detail (stage calculations).

Discovery	Profiles + timing	G	After demographics	A	Submitted	G rationale
Sequencing-by-synthesis	3%	1.04	3%	1.60	5%	UK analytical platform

Discovery	Profiles + timing	G	After demographics	A	Submitted	G rationale
Controlled radical polymerization	4%	1.04	4%	1.15	4%	US/Japan synthesis
Solid-state perovskites	4%	0.94	3%	1.10	3%	Recent materials mix
Drug/nucleic-acid nanoparticles	4%	0.99	4%	1.15	4%	Canada; near-neutral
Phosphoramidite synthesis	3%	1.04	3%	1.00	3%	US synthesis tool
C–H functionalization	2%	1.04	2%	1.00	2%	US catalysis
Nanopore methods	5%	1.04	5%	1.00	4%	UK/US analytical tool
Self-assembled monolayers	5%	1.04	6%	1.35	7%	US surface/physical chemistry
Protein electron transfer	<1%	1.04	<1%	1.50	1%	US bioinorganic chemistry
Base/prime editing	3%	1.00	3%	1.20	4%	Chemical biology; neutral
Targeted degradation	3%	1.02	3%	1.35	3%	US chemical biology
Ab initio dynamics	3%	1.04	3%	1.00	3%	International physical theory
Molecular chaperones	3%	1.01	3%	1.10	3%	US/German biochemistry
Dye + perovskite cells	2%	0.94	2%	1.05	2%	Solar materials
OLEDs	3%	0.94	3%	1.00	3%	Industrial materials
DNA origami	2%	0.98	2%	1.00	2%	Nano/bio interface
Pd carbon–heteroatom coupling	4%	1.04	5%	1.05	4%	US synthesis

Discovery	Profiles + timing	G	After demographics	A	Submitted	G rationale
DNA synthesis + sequencing	2%	1.04	2%	1.15	2%	UK/US analytical synthesis
DFT functionals	3%	1.04	3%	1.00	3%	US physical theory
Chemical genetics/KRAS	3%	1.02	3%	1.00	3%	US chemical biology
Genetic-code expansion	5%	1.02	5%	1.10	5%	US/UK chemical biology
Atomic layer deposition	1%	0.94	1%	1.20	1%	Finnish materials
Carbohydrate synthesis	3%	1.03	3%	1.00	3%	US/Taiwan synthesis
MS-based proteomics	7%	1.04	8%	1.35	9%	International analytical biology
Dye-sensitized cells	7%	0.94	7%	1.05	6%	Solar materials
Stable carbenes/NHCs	3%	1.04	3%	1.00	3%	US/European synthesis
Bacterial communication	2%	1.08	2%	1.00	2%	Biology + mixed gender
Photocatalytic water splitting	3%	0.94	3%	1.00	2%	Japanese energy materials
Proton-coupled electron transfer	1%	1.10	1%	1.00	1%	Physical theory + mixed gender
Nuclear receptors	6%	1.01	6%	1.00	5%	US biochemistry

For the leading three discoveries, my expected laureate sets are attribution judgments:

- Proteomics: John R. Yates III, Matthias Mann and Ruedi Aebersold. Original method papers distribute credit across experimental and computational contributors; the award institution corroborates this complementary platform-level trio (Gairdner).

- SAMs: David L. Allara, Ralph G. Nuzzo and George M. Whitesides, for a motivation covering formation, characterization and surface engineering. Jacob Sagiv is the strongest alternative if original oxide-surface chemistry dominates. Kavli explicitly distinguishes these contributions (Kavli attribution).
- Dye-sensitized cells: Michael Grätzel and Brian O'Regan, the two authors of the decisive cell paper. There is no reason to fill a third slot (original paper).

What's non-obvious

The question rewards a discovery match, not a perfect name list. A SAM award including Sagiv, or a dye-cell award including O'Regan, still matches the relevant option. Conversely, adding famous names to a composite DNA or solar option does not make that option more likely to resolve: the motivation must be broad enough to beat the narrower alternative (resolution and specificity audit). Credit uncertainty and discovery uncertainty are different things.

A prior Nobel in an enabling technique is not an automatic veto on a later platform. Soft ionization and large-scale quantitative proteomics are connected, but they are not identical contributions (official motivation; systems-proteomics attribution). The opposite mistake is letting a career's most-cited papers stand in for a missing discovery: Gray's outside recognition strengthens his case, but it cannot erase the card's lack of direct protein-electron-transfer work under this profile-led framework (supplied allocation; Clarivate).

Uncertainties

The largest missing evidence is the committee's actual shortlist and motivation. Nominations and deliberative material remain confidential for 50 years, so public accomplishments cannot establish which discoveries reached the final comparison (selection rules). Contribution statements would also sharpen laureate allocation: first or last authorship alone does not prove sole conception, and SAMs has a documented four-person credit pool (Kavli credit record).

The cards are descriptive records ending in 2021, not complete discovery histories. The stated attribution anomalies and recent uptake limits remain material even after explicit attenuation (data coverage and flags). The scoring weights and demographic factors are judgments, not fitted coefficients. In 30,000 score-perturbation tests, proteomics spans roughly 6–12% between the tenth and ninetieth percentiles; this is a model-sensitivity range, not a statistical confidence interval (sensitivity calculation). The submitted digits preserve normalization, not knowledge at twelve-decimal precision.

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<https://www.gmwgroup.harvard.edu/patents>
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Question Details

The 2026 Nobel Prize in Chemistry is scheduled to be announced on Wednesday 7 October 2026. Each option names a discovery and the people most closely associated with it. The forecast is conditional on the prize going to one of the listed discoveries; there is no "Other" option.

Resolution Criteria

Resolves to the option whose discovery matches the discovery named in the official motivation of the 2026 Nobel Prize in Chemistry, as published at nobelprize.org. Options are matched by discovery; the people named in an option need not match the laureates exactly. If the prize is divided between two discoveries, only the discovery with the larger share counts; if the shares are equal, the discovery named first in the announcement counts. If more than one option matches, the option that names the awarded discovery most specifically counts. If no option matches that discovery, the question is annulled (the forecast is conditional on one of the listed discoveries).